

Study Questions: Communication — Stories Told Over Stitches

1. Describe the **dual-channel communication system** of a crochet circle. What does each channel carry, and how do they operate simultaneously?
2. When Priya pauses mid-story to focus on a tricky cable stitch, what is happening in terms of **precision weighting** and attentional allocation between channels?
3. How do the **physical** and **social channels** interact? Give an example of information flowing from one channel to the other during a circle meeting.
4. Explain how **craft stories** function as cultural transmission. Why are narratives more memorable and deeply encoded than abstract instructions?
5. Give an example of a **craft-life fusion story** — a narrative that weaves crochet with personal experience. How does such a story enrich the circle's shared generative model?
6. How do **life stories** told in the circle build social bonds and shared identity? Why does the crochet setting make these stories more likely to be shared?
7. A crochet pattern is described as an "inherently incomplete" communication artifact. What does the pattern communicate, and what does it leave out?
8. When a circle member shares a pattern and says "Row 12 is confusing, just ask me when you get there," they are transmitting **metacognitive knowledge**. Explain what this means and why it is valuable.
9. How does **pattern sharing** in a circle differ from simply downloading a pattern from the internet? What does the social context add?
10. Compare the communicative capacity of **in-person circles** with **online communities** (forums, social media). What does each provide that the other lacks?

11. How does **video** (YouTube tutorials) attempt to capture the dual-channel communication of a circle? Where does it succeed, and where does it fall short?
12. The physical rhythm of crochet creates a unique conversational quality. Explain why **hands busy with repetitive work** might lead to deeper, more intimate conversation.
13. Describe an example of **silent communication** in a crochet circle — a message carried entirely through the physical channel without words. What makes this effective?
14. How do **group chats and messaging** between meetings extend the circle's social channel? What do they maintain that would be lost without them?
15. When a circle member posts a photo of their finished project on Instagram, this is communication through the physical channel to a wider audience. How does this act function as an **active state** in the circle's Markov blanket?
16. How do **inside jokes and recurring references** function as communication within the circle? What do they signal about group membership?
17. A new member does not yet understand the circle's inside references and communication shorthand. How does this communication gap reflect the difference between their generative model and the group's shared model?
18. How does the **quality of conversation** in a crochet circle differ from a conversation in a setting where no one is doing handwork? What does the physical activity contribute?
19. Consider a circle that communicates only online (a virtual crochet group). What happens to the dual-channel system? Can the two channels still operate, and if so, how?
20. Reflect on the relationship between communication and all the previous modules (systems, agents, perception, cognition, action, learning). How does communication depend on and integrate all of these?